FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-20-21001

Issue Title : TE Connectivity BMS13-48 Non-Conformance

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2097-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
787, 767, 777, 747, 737NG	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
04/27/2021	09/12/2024	07/16/2024

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date

Revision Description

Updated milestones.

Description

Boeing received a quality alert notification from TE Connectivity regarding a wet arc testing failure on their BMS13-48 product line. Per their investigation, it was determined that shipments of the product from October 22, 2010 and on may have the potential to not meet Wet Arc Resistance per BMS 13-48 specification.

Background

After TE moved their wet arc test equipment to a new lab, they conducted validation testing, and a failure for wet arc resistance testing was recorded against the BMS 13-48 specification. Their test on one sample had 4 wires failed, while the specification allows a maximum of 3 wires to fail. Wet Arc Resistance tests the ability of the insulation of wires within a wire harness to resist arcs from occurring and also from propagating throughout the wire harness in a situation where the wire insulation has been damaged such that the conductors are visible and conductive fluids are present.

Root cause investigation of the testing failure determined that their Wet Arc Resistance setup was not an issue. Therefore, there is a potential quality issue with the BMS13-48 product manufactured. TE Connectivity identified the timeframe of the shipments of the product which have the potential to not have Wet Arc Resistance per BMS 13-48. TE Connectivity have requalified their BMS 13-48 product to conform to the BMS13-48 specifications.

Status

After further review of the BMS13-48 specification and risk mitigation testing, it was concluded to reduce the scope of the Notice of Escapement to only non-conforming 8-mil insulation thickness wire and cable Types. The wire types that are impacted as follows:

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8-mil dual wall wire constructions:

T10, T11, T31, T35, T59

8-mil dual wall cable constructions:

T12, T13, T14, T27, T28, T32, T36, T37, T38, T39, T42, T43, T50, T51, T53, T55, T56, T57, T58, T60, T61, T62, T63, T64

Boeing's review of the Notice of Escapement determined that the BMS 13-48 Cable Types 12, 13, 14, 27, 28, 32, 36, 37, 38, 39, 42, 43, 50, 51, 53, 55, 56, 57, 58, 60, 61, 62, 63, and 64 which use Component Wire Types with 8-mil nominal insulation thickness (Types 10, 11, 31, 35, and 59) are less susceptible to conditions that could cause an arc fault due to the increased thickness of the added cable layers around the Component Wires. Boeing's disposition for these cable types is "Use-As-Is"

For BMS 13-48 Wire Types 10, 11, 31, 35, and 59, a corresponding installation-specific assessment and review was conducted for each Boeing airplane model to identify high-risk areas and determine if all wire harnesses containing those BMS13-48 Types from TE could be acceptable to "Use-As-Is" or if some specific harnesses were not acceptable for a "Use As-Is" and required additional mitigation.

This safety assessment / design review focused on all harnesses using these BMS13-48 Types that meet the following criteria:

- Installed BMS13-48 wiring with 8-mil insulation that is not jacketed or shielded (Types 10, 11, 31, 35, and 59).

- Wires carries 115V AC or greater

- Located in Unpressurized or Transitional area

- Located in the Flammable Leakage Zone

- Eliminate wiring installations that had mitigations in place, such as presence of protective sleeves, conduits, convoluted tubing, over-braid, structure, panels, boxes, etc.

The review on the 737MAX model found that adequate mitigation were in place for all installations. All wire harness installation of the BMS 13-48 Types 10, 11, 31, 35, and 59 are acceptable. The disposition is "Use-As-Is"

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Interim Action

None.

Final Action

Information only, no action required. The wires are acceptable to use as-is.

Milestones

Boeing Review of Installations: March 2021 (complete)

TE Connectivitiy BMS 13-48 Requalification: July 2024 (complete)

Related Categories

- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability

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